VENVLEARNING

STUDENT TEXTBOOK



Spanish Español

GRADE 4

Lessons, examples, and practice for the whole year

2026–2027 School Year · Unit 1: ¡Hola!

VENVLEARNING

Grade 4
Spanish Español

STUDENT TEXTBOOK

2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 ¡Hola!

This book belongs to _____

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this book

Each lesson starts with an I can goal and a Para Empezar question. Read the lesson with your teacher. Listen and repeat the new words, study the Modelo boxes, and practice speaking with a partner every day. Your practice pages are in your Student Workbook, labeled with the same lesson number.

- Key Idea boxes hold the most important rule or fact. Learn these.
- Watch Out boxes warn you about common mistakes.
- Sounds like columns show how to say each word; the CAPITAL syllable gets the stress. Hear any word at SpanishDict.com.
- Diálogo boxes are conversations. Read them aloud with a partner, then change the details to talk about yourself.
- Every Friday there is a short Weekly Check in your workbook. The last Friday of a unit is the Unit Test.

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UNIT 1

¡Hola!

Greetings, names, feelings, courtesy, Spanish sounds and the alphabet, classroom Spanish, tú and usted, numbers 0–10, and age.

¡Bienvenidos! (Welcome!) In your first unit you'll learn to greet people, introduce yourself, say how you feel and how old you are, and be polite, all in Spanish. You'll learn the sounds of Spanish so you can read new words aloud, the classroom phrases you'll use every day, and how Spanish connects to Mississippi's own history.

In this unit you will…

- Greet, introduce yourself, and say goodbye.
- Say how you feel and how old you are.
- Pronounce Spanish vowels and letters; spell aloud.
- Use classroom commands and questions; choose tú or usted.

EL MUNDO HISPANOHABLANTE

Over 40 million people in the United States speak Spanish at home. Even a few phrases let you greet neighbors and make new friends.

UNIT VOCABULARY

¡Hola!	Hello!
Me llamo…	My name is…
¿Cómo estás?	How are you?
gracias	thank you
usted	polite you
Tengo ___ años.	I'm ___ years old.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
1.1	¡Hola! Saying Hello and Goodbye

Lesson	Title
1.2	¿Cómo te llamas? Names
1.3	¿Cómo estás? Feelings
1.4	Por favor y gracias: Being Polite
1.5	The Five Vowel Sounds
1.6	The Spanish Alphabet
1.7	Accent Marks and Upside-Down Punctuation
1.8	¿Cómo se escribe? Spelling Out Loud
1.9	Classroom Commands
1.10	Questions You Need in Class
1.11	Tú and Usted: Friendly and Polite You
1.12	Cultura: Greetings Around the Spanish-Speaking World
1.13	Los números 0–10
1.14	¿Cuántos años tienes? Age
1.15	Todo junto: My First Spanish Conversation
1.16	Cultura: Mississippi's Spanish Past

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal

Lesson 1.1: ¡Hola! Saying Hello and Goodbye

I can greet people and say goodbye at different times of day.

WORDS TO KNOW

saludo	a greeting
despedida	a goodbye

PARA EMPEZAR

How many ways do you say hello and goodbye in English? Do you say “Good morning” at night?

Spanish speakers greet each other a lot, and it's polite to say hello when you walk into a room or a store. Like English, Spanish has greetings for different times of day.

Saludos (Greetings)

Español	Sounds like	English
¡Hola!	OH-lah	Hi! / Hello!
Buenos días.	BWEH-nohs DEE-ahs	Good morning.
Buenas tardes.	BWEH-nahs TAR-dehs	Good afternoon.
Buenas noches.	BWEH-nahs NOH-chehs	Good evening. / Good night.

Despedidas (Goodbyes)

Español	Sounds like	English
¡Adiós!	ah-DYOHS	Goodbye!
Hasta luego.	AHS-tah LWEH-goh	See you later.
Hasta mañana.	AHS-tah mah-NYAH-nah	See you tomorrow.
Chao.	chow	Bye.

WATCH OUT

In Spanish, the letter h is silent. Say “OH-lah,” not “HOH-lah.”

DIÁLOGO · EN LA MAÑANA

Ana: ¡Hola, Luis! Buenos días.
Hi, Luis! Good morning.

Luis: ¡Hola, Ana! Buenos días.
Hi, Ana! Good morning.

Ana: ¡Adiós! Hasta luego.
Bye! See you later.

Luis: ¡Hasta luego!
See you later!

ESCUCHA · LISTEN

- Hear any word or phrase · SpanishDict.com (type the word, press the speaker) (free)
- Spanish Learning Lab · spanishlearninglab.com (greetings and alphabet audio lessons) (free)

KEY IDEA

Buenos días (morning), buenas tardes (afternoon), buenas noches (evening/night). The h in hola is silent.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. How do you say “Good afternoon”?
2. What does “Hasta mañana” mean?
3. It's 8:00 at night. Which greeting?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Buenos días, buenas tardes, buenas noches; adiós, hasta luego.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal

Lesson 1.2: ¿Cómo te llamas? Names

I can ask someone's name and tell my name.

WORDS TO KNOW

¿Cómo te llamas?	What's your name?
Me llamo...	My name is...
Mucho gusto.	Nice to meet you.

PARA EMPEZAR

When you meet a new kid at the park, what do you say first?

Names

Español	Sounds like	English
¿Cómo te llamas?	KOH-moh teh YAH-mahs	What's your name?
Me llamo ___.	meh YAH-moh	My name is ___.
¿Y tú?	ee TOO	And you?
Mucho gusto.	MOO-choh GOOS-toh	Nice to meet you.
Igualmente.	ee-gwahl-MEHN-teh	Likewise.

WATCH OUT

In Spanish, ll sounds like the English y in “yes.” Llamo sounds like “YAH-moh.”

DIÁLOGO · EN EL PARQUE

Sofía: ¡Hola! ¿Cómo te llamas?

Hi! What's your name?

Mateo: Me llamo Mateo. ¿Y tú?

My name is Mateo. And you?

Sofía: Me llamo Sofía. Mucho gusto.

My name is Sofía. Nice to meet you.

Mateo: Igualmente.

Likewise.

CULTURA

Many Spanish speakers have two last names: the first from their father and the second from their mother. If Mateo's father is José García and his mother is Ana López, he might be Mateo García López.

KEY IDEA

¿Cómo te llamas? → Me llamo ___. ¿Y tú? → Mucho gusto.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Ask “What's your name?”
2. Answer with your name.
3. How does ll sound?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

¿Cómo te llamas? Me llamo ___. Mucho gusto.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal

Lesson 1.3: ¿Cómo estás? Feelings

I can ask how someone is and say how I feel.

WORDS TO KNOW

¿Cómo estás?	How are you?
Estoy...	I am... (feeling)

PARA EMPEZAR

How are you feeling right now? Pick one word.

¿Cómo estás?

Español	Sounds like	English
Estoy bien.	ehs-TOY byehn	I'm fine/well.
Muy bien.	mwee byehn	Very well.
Así así. / Más o menos.	ah-SEE ah-SEE / MAHS oh MEH-nohs	So-so.
Mal.	mahl	Bad.
Estoy cansado. / cansada.	kahn-SAH-doh / kahn-SAH-dah	I'm tired.
Estoy contento. / contenta.	kohn-TEHN-toh / kohn-TEHN-tah	I'm happy.
Estoy triste.	TREES-teh	I'm sad.
Estoy enfermo. / enferma.	ehn-FEHR-moh / ehn-FEHR-mah	I'm sick.

MODELO · BOY OR GIRL?

Many feeling words change their last letter.

1 A boy says: Estoy cansado. (ends in -o)

2 A girl says: Estoy cansada. (ends in -a)

3 Some words don't change: Estoy triste. Estoy bien.

Respuesta: Words ending in -o often change to -a for girls and women.

DIÁLOGO · ¿QUÉ TAL?

Lucía:	¡Hola, Diego! ¿Cómo estás?
Diego:	Estoy cansado. ¿Y tú?
Lucía:	¡Estoy muy bien, gracias!

KEY IDEA

¿Cómo estás? → Estoy bien / mal / cansado(a) / contento(a) / triste.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. How do you say “I'm sad”?
2. A girl is tired. What does she say?
3. What does “Así así” mean?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

¿Cómo estás? Estoy bien, contento/contenta, triste…

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal

Lesson 1.4: Por favor y gracias: Being Polite

I can use polite words and put greetings together in a short conversation.

WORDS TO KNOW

por favor	please
gracias	thank you
de nada	you're welcome

PARA EMPEZAR

What polite words do you use every day without thinking?

Palabras de cortesía

Español	Sounds like	English
Por favor.	pohr fah-VOHR	Please.
Gracias.	GRAH-syahs	Thank you.
Muchas gracias.	MOO-chahs GRAH-syahs	Thank you very much.
De nada.	deh NAH-dah	You're welcome.
Lo siento.	loh SYEHN-toh	I'm sorry.
Perdón. / Con permiso.	pehr-DOHN / kohn pehr-MEE-soh	Excuse me.

DIÁLOGO · TODO JUNTO (ALL TOGETHER)

Pablo: ¡Buenas tardes! ¿Cómo te llamas?

Elena: Me llamo Elena. ¿Y tú?

Pablo: Me llamo Pablo. Mucho gusto. ¿Cómo estás?

Elena: Estoy bien, gracias. ¿Y tú?

Pablo: Muy bien. ¡Hasta luego!

Elena: ¡Adiós!

KEY IDEA

Greeting → name → feelings → goodbye, with por favor and gracias along the way.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. "Thank you very much" =
2. Someone says "Gracias." You answer…
3. You bump into someone. Say…

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use por favor, gracias, de nada in a full conversation.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · ACTFL Novice · Presentational

Lesson 1.5: The Five Vowel Sounds

I can pronounce the five Spanish vowels clearly.

WORDS TO KNOW

vocal vowel

PARA EMPEZAR

English vowels make many sounds (think of the a in cat, cake, and car). How many sounds do you think Spanish vowels make?

Good news: each Spanish vowel makes just one short, clear sound. Learn these five and you can read almost any Spanish word aloud.

Las vocales

Español	Sounds like	English
a	ah (as in father)	casa (KAH-sah) house
e	eh (as in met)	mesa (MEH-sah) table
i	ee (as in see)	sí (see) yes
o	oh (short, as in no)	oso (OH-soh) bear
u	oo (as in food)	uno (OO-noh) one

MODELO · READ NEW WORDS

Read aloud: mamá, papá, piso, luna, Pepe

1 Say each vowel with its one sound.

2 mah-MAH, pah-PAH, PEE-soh, LOO-nah, PEH-peh

Respuesta: If you know the vowels, you can sound out words you've never seen.

CANCIÓN

Sing “A, E, I, O, U, el burro sabe más que tú” (“the donkey knows more than you”), a vowel song many Spanish-speaking children learn. Search the title to hear it.

KEY IDEA

a = ah, e = eh, i = ee, o = oh, u = oo, always.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Sound of e

2. Sound of i

3. Read aloud: luna

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Each Spanish vowel has one clear sound.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · ACTFL Novice · Interpretive

Lesson 1.6: The Spanish Alphabet

I can say the Spanish alphabet and recognize letters with special sounds.

WORDS TO KNOW

el alfabeto	the alphabet
la letra	the letter

PARA EMPEZAR

Do you think Spanish has more letters, fewer, or the same number as English?

The Spanish alphabet has 27 letters: the same 26 as English plus ñ. Some letters sound different from English.

Letter	Name	Sound tip
h	hache (AH-cheh)	always silent: hola
j	jota (HOH-tah)	like a strong English h: jugo (HOO-goh)
ll (two letters)	doble ele	like y in yes: llamo
ñ	eñe (EH-nyeh)	like ny in canyon: mañana
rr (two letters)	doble erre	rolled r: perro (PEH-rroh)
v	uve or ve (OO-veh / veh)	sounds almost like b: vaca
z	zeta (SEH-tah)	like s in Latin America: zapato

The other letter names are close to English: a (ah), be (beh), ce (seh), de (deh), e (eh), efe (EH-feh), ge (heh), i (ee), ka (kah), ele (EH-leh), eme (EH-meh), ene (EH-neh), o (oh), pe (peh), cu (koo), erre (EH-rreh), ese (EH-seh), te (teh), u (oo), doble uve (DOH-bleh OO-veh), equis (EH-kees), ye (yeh).

ESCUCHA · LISTEN

- Hear any word or phrase · SpanishDict.com (type the word, press the speaker) (free)
- Spanish Learning Lab · spanishlearninglab.com (greetings and alphabet audio lessons) (free)

KEY IDEA

27 letters, including ñ. Watch for h (silent), j (strong h), ll (y), ñ (ny), and rr (rolled).

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. How many letters in the Spanish alphabet?
2. What sound does ñ make?
3. Which letter is silent?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

27 letters, with special h, j, ll, ñ, rr.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · ACTFL Novice · Presentational

Lesson 1.7: Accent Marks and Upside-Down Punctuation

I can explain what accent marks and ¿ ¡ do and use them when I write.

WORDS TO KNOW

acento	accent mark (´), which shows the stressed syllable
signos de interrogación	question marks: ¿ ?
signos de exclamación	exclamation marks: ¡ !

PARA EMPEZAR

Look at this: ¿Cómo estás? What do you notice that English doesn't do?

Spanish puts an upside-down question mark ¿ at the start of a question and an upside-down exclamation mark ¡ at the start of an exclamation, so readers know right away how to read the sentence.

An accent mark (´) shows which part of the word to say louder: adiós (ah-DYOHS), mamá (mah-MAH). Sometimes an accent changes the meaning: sí means yes, but si means if; tú means you, but tu means your.

MODELO · WRITE IT CORRECTLY

Fix: hola como estas

1 Start the exclamation with ¡ and end with !: ¡Hola!

2 Start the question with ¿ and end with ?.

3 Add accents: Cómo, estás.

Respuesta: ¡Hola! ¿Cómo estás?

KEY IDEA

¿...? and ¡...! wrap questions and exclamations. Accent marks show stress and can change meaning.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Fix: como te llamas?
2. Meaning of sí
3. Where does ¡ go?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

¿Questions? ¡Exclamations! Accents show stress.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal

Lesson 1.8: ¿Cómo se escribe? Spelling Out Loud

I can spell my name and simple words aloud in Spanish.

WORDS TO KNOW

¿Cómo se escribe?	How do you spell it?
Se escribe...	It's spelled...

PARA EMPEZAR

When might you need to spell your name for someone?

DIÁLOGO · EN LA BIBLIOTECA

Señora: ¿Cómo te llamas?
What's your name?

Niño: Me llamo Noé.

Señora: ¿Cómo se escribe?
How do you spell it?

Niño: Se escribe ene - o - e, con acento.

It's spelled N-O-E, with an accent.

MODELO · SPELL A NAME

Spell “Ana” and “Hugo” aloud.

1 Ana: a - ene - a

2 Hugo: hache - u - ge - o

Respuesta: Use the Spanish letter names.

KEY IDEA

¿Cómo se escribe? → Se escribe... + letter names.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Spell “sol” aloud.
2. Ask “How do you spell it?”
3. Spell “mamá” aloud.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

¿Cómo se escribe? Use Spanish letter names.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.9 · ACTFL Novice · Interpretive

Lesson 1.9: Classroom Commands

I can understand and follow common classroom instructions in Spanish.

WORDS TO KNOW

mandato a command

PARA EMPEZAR

Your teacher says “¡Siéntate!” and points to a chair. What do you think it means?

En la clase

Español	Sounds like	English
Escucha.	ehs-KOO-chah	Listen.
Mira.	MEE-rah	Look.
Repite.	reh-PEE-teh	Repeat.
Siéntate.	SYEHN-tah-teh	Sit down.
Levántate.	leh-VAHN-tah-teh	Stand up.
Abre el libro.	AH-breh ehl LEE-broh	Open the book.
Cierra el libro.	SYEH-rrah ehl LEE-broh	Close the book.
Levanta la mano.	leh-VAHN-tah lah MAH-noh	Raise your hand.
Escribe.	ehs-KREE-beh	Write.

JUEGO

Play Simón dice (Simon Says): “Simón dice: ¡levántate!” Only follow commands that start with “Simón dice.”

KEY IDEA

Learn commands by doing them: escucha, mira, repite, siéntate, levántate, abre, cierra, levanta la mano, escribe.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Meaning of Mira
2. Meaning of Siéntate
3. Say “Raise your hand.”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Escucha, mira, repite, siéntate, levántate…

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.10 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal

Lesson 1.10: Questions You Need in Class

I can ask for help, meaning, and permission in Spanish.

WORDS TO KNOW

pregunta a question

PARA EMPEZAR

What would you need to say if you didn't understand your Spanish teacher?

Preguntas útiles (Useful questions)

Español	Sounds like	English
¿Cómo se dice ___ en español?	KOH-moh seh DEE-seh … ehn ehs-pah-NYOHL	How do you say ___ in Spanish?
¿Qué significa ___?	keh seeg-nee-FEE-kah	What does ___ mean?
No entiendo.	noh ehn-TYEHN-doh	I don't understand.
Más despacio, por favor.	mahs dehs-PAH-syoh pohr fah-VOHR	Slower, please.
Otra vez, por favor.	OH-trah vehs	Again, please.
¿Puedo ir al baño?	PWEH-doh eer ahl BAH-nyoh	May I go to the bathroom?

MODELO · USE IT

You don't know the Spanish word for cat.

1 Ask: ¿Cómo se dice “cat” en español?

2 Teacher: Se dice “gato.”

3 You: Gracias.

Respuesta: Now you can learn any word you need!

KEY IDEA

¿Cómo se dice…? ¿Qué significa…? No entiendo. Más despacio, por favor.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Ask how to say “dog” in Spanish.
2. Say “I don't understand.”
3. Meaning of “Otra vez, por favor”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Ask for help in Spanish.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.11 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal; Cultures

Lesson 1.11: Tú and Usted: Friendly and Polite You

I can choose between tú and usted and greet adults politely.

WORDS TO KNOW

tú	you (friendly: friends, family, kids)
usted	you (polite: adults you don't know well, teachers, elders)
señor / señora / señorita	Mr. / Mrs. (Ma'am) / Miss

PARA EMPEZAR

Do you talk to your best friend and to a doctor exactly the same way?

Spanish has two ways to say you. Use tú with friends, family, and other kids. Use usted to show respect to adults you don't know well, teachers, and older people.

	Friendly (tú)	Polite (usted)
How are you?	¿Cómo estás?	¿Cómo está usted?
What's your name?	¿Cómo te llamas?	¿Cómo se llama usted?
And you?	¿Y tú?	¿Y usted?

Titles

Español	Sounds like	English
señor	seh-NYOHR	Mr. / sir
señora	seh-NYOH-rah	Mrs. / ma'am
señorita	seh-nyoh-REE-tah	Miss

DIÁLOGO · CON LA VECINA (WITH THE NEIGHBOR)

Niña: ¡Buenos días, señora Ruiz! ¿Cómo está usted?

Sra. Ruiz: Muy bien, gracias. ¿Y tú?

Niña: Bien, gracias.

The girl uses usted with the adult; the adult uses tú with the child.

KEY IDEA

Tú for friends and family; usted for respect.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Tú or usted: your cousin
2. Tú or usted: a new doctor
3. Polite: How are you?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Tú is friendly; usted is respectful.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.12 · ACTFL Cultures, Comparisons

Lesson 1.12: Cultura: Greetings Around the Spanish-Speaking World

I can name some places where Spanish is spoken and compare greeting customs.

WORDS TO KNOW

país	country
hispanohablante	Spanish-speaking

PARA EMPEZAR

When you meet someone, do you shake hands, wave, hug, or something else?

Spanish is an official language in 20 countries and in Puerto Rico, a U.S. territory. It's spoken in Spain, Mexico, most of Central and South America, and parts of the Caribbean, plus Equatorial Guinea in Africa. Millions of people in the United States speak Spanish too.

Region	Some countries
Europe	España (Spain)
North America	México
Central America	Guatemala, Honduras, El Salvador, Nicaragua, Costa Rica, Panamá
Caribbean	Cuba, República Dominicana, Puerto Rico (U.S. territory)
South America	Colombia, Venezuela, Ecuador, Perú, Bolivia, Chile, Argentina, Uruguay, Paraguay
Africa	Guinea Ecuatorial

CULTURA

In many Spanish-speaking places, friends and family greet with a light kiss on the cheek or a hug, and adults often shake hands. In Spain, friends may kiss on both cheeks. Kids usually greet adults with “Buenos días” or “Buenas tardes,” even when entering a store.

KEY IDEA

Spanish connects about 20 countries and Puerto Rico; greeting customs are warm and polite.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. How many countries have Spanish as an official language?
2. Name a Spanish-speaking country in South America.
3. Name one greeting custom.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Spanish is spoken in 20 countries plus Puerto Rico.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.13 · ACTFL Novice · Interpretive

Lesson 1.13: Los números 0–10

I can count from 0 to 10 and use numbers in simple sentences.

WORDS TO KNOW

número	number
¿Cuántos?	How many?

PARA EMPEZAR

Where do you see numbers every day?

Números 0–10

Español	Sounds like	English
0 cero	SEH-roh	
1 uno	OO-noh	
2 dos	dohs	
3 tres	trehs	
4 cuatro	KWAH-troh	
5 cinco	SEEN-koh	
6 seis	says	
7 siete	SYEH-teh	
8 ocho	OH-choh	
9 nueve	NWEH-veh	

Español	Sounds like	English
10 diez	dyehs	

MODELO · COUNT AND ANSWER

¿Cuántos lápices hay? (How many pencils are there?) — 4 pencils

1 Count: uno, dos, tres, cuatro.

2 Answer: Hay cuatro lápices.

Respuesta: Hay cuatro. (There are four.)

KEY IDEA

cero, uno, dos, tres, cuatro, cinco, seis, siete, ocho, nueve, diez.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. 7 =

2. nueve =

3. 3 + 2 = ?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Count cero to diez.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.14 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal

Lesson 1.14: ¿Cuántos años tienes? Age

I can ask someone's age and tell mine.

WORDS TO KNOW

¿Cuántos años tienes?	How old are you?
Tengo ___ años.	I am ___ years old.

PARA EMPEZAR

In English we say "I am nine." What do you think Spanish says?

Spanish uses the verb tener (to have) for age. Instead of "I am nine," you say "I have nine years": Tengo nueve años.

Age

Español	Sounds like	English
¿Cuántos años tienes?	KWAHN-tohs AH-nyohs TYEH-nehs	How old are you?
Tengo nueve años.	TEHN-goh NWEH-veh AH-nyohs	I'm nine years old.
Tengo diez años.	TEHN-goh dyehs AH-nyohs	I'm ten years old.

WATCH OUT

Don't forget the ñ: años means years. Without the ñ, the word means something else, so the little ~ matters!

DIÁLOGO · NUEVOS AMIGOS

Rosa:	¿Cuántos años tienes?
Tomás:	Tengo nueve años. ¿Y tú?
Rosa:	Tengo diez años.

KEY IDEA

¿Cuántos años tienes? → Tengo ___ años. Spanish uses tener for age.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. How old are you? (in Spanish)
2. I'm 8 years old.
3. Which verb does Spanish use for age?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Tengo ___ años.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.15 · ACTFL Novice · Interpersonal, Presentational

Lesson 1.15: Todo junto: My First Spanish Conversation

I can hold a short conversation: greet, give my name, say how I feel, tell my age, and say goodbye.

PARA EMPEZAR

Put it all together: how much can you say about yourself in Spanish now?

DIÁLOGO · UNA CONVERSACIÓN COMPLETA

Carla:	¡Hola! Buenas tardes.
Beto:	¡Hola! Buenas tardes.
Carla:	¿Cómo te llamas?
Beto:	Me llamo Beto. ¿Y tú?
Carla:	Me llamo Carla. Mucho gusto.
Beto:	Igualmente. ¿Cómo estás?
Carla:	Estoy contenta. ¿Y tú?
Beto:	Estoy bien, gracias. ¿Cuántos años tienes?
Carla:	Tengo diez años. ¿Y tú?

Beto:	Tengo nueve años. ¡Hasta luego!
Carla:	¡Adiós!

Presentación: Prepare a short introduction about yourself (4–5 sentences) to present to your family: greeting, name, feeling, age, and goodbye.

MODELO · MODEL PRESENTATION

Mi presentación

1 ¡Hola! Buenos días.
2 Me llamo Tomás.
3 Estoy muy bien.
4 Tengo nueve años.
5 ¡Adiós!

Respuesta: Short, clear, and all in Spanish.

KEY IDEA

Greeting → name → feeling → age → goodbye.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Respond: ¿Cómo te llamas?
2. Respond: ¿Cuántos años tienes?
3. Respond: ¿Cómo estás?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Greet, name, feeling, age, goodbye: a whole conversation!

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.16 · ACTFL Cultures, Connections

Lesson 1.16: Cultura: Mississippi's Spanish Past

I can describe how Spain is part of Mississippi's history.

WORDS TO KNOW

historia	history
fuerte	fort

PARA EMPEZAR

Is Spanish something new in Mississippi, or has it been here a long time?

Spanish has a long history in Mississippi. In 1540–1541, the Spanish explorer Hernando de Soto led an expedition through the land that is now Mississippi. Much later, Spain governed Natchez from 1779 to 1798, and Spain controlled the Mississippi Gulf Coast as part of Spanish West Florida until about 1810.

In Pascagoula stands the La Pointe-Krebs House, often called the Old Spanish Fort. Despite the name, it was built by French colonists in the 1700s and is believed to be one of the oldest buildings in Mississippi. Your family's field trip there is a chance to see this history up close.

CULTURA HOY

Today many Mississippians speak Spanish at home, and you can find Spanish on signs, in stores, on the radio, and at church services. Learning Spanish helps you talk with your neighbors.

KEY IDEA

Spanish explorers and governors are part of Mississippi's story, and Spanish is part of Mississippi life today.

¡PRACTICA!

Say each answer out loud first, then write it. Check with your teacher.

1. Which Spanish explorer passed through Mississippi in 1540–1541?
2. Which city did Spain govern from 1779 to 1798?
3. Who built the “Old Spanish Fort”?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Spain is part of Mississippi's history and present.

UNIT 1 REVIEW

Unit 1 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
1.1	Buenos días, buenas tardes, buenas noches; adiós, hasta luego.
1.2	¿Cómo te llamas? Me llamo ___. Mucho gusto.
1.3	¿Cómo estás? Estoy bien, contento/contenta, triste…
1.4	Use por favor, gracias, de nada in a full conversation.
1.5	Each Spanish vowel has one clear sound.
1.6	27 letters, with special h, j, ll, ñ, rr.
1.7	¿Questions? ¡Exclamations! Accents show stress.
1.8	¿Cómo se escribe? Use Spanish letter names.
1.9	Escucha, mira, repite, siéntate, levántate…
1.10	Ask for help in Spanish.
1.11	Tú is friendly; usted is respectful.
1.12	Spanish is spoken in 20 countries plus Puerto Rico.
1.13	Count cero to diez.
1.14	Tengo ___ años.
1.15	Greet, name, feeling, age, goodbye: a whole conversation!
1.16	Spain is part of Mississippi's history and present.

Glossary

acento	accent mark (´), which shows the stressed syllable
de nada	you're welcome
despedida	a goodbye
el alfabeto	the alphabet
Estoy...	I am... (feeling)
fuerte	fort
gracias	thank you
hispanohablante	Spanish-speaking
historia	history
la letra	the letter
mandato	a command
Me llamo...	My name is...
Mucho gusto.	Nice to meet you.
número	number
país	country
por favor	please
pregunta	a question
saludo	a greeting
Se escribe...	It's spelled...
señor / señora / señorita	Mr. / Mrs. (Ma'am) / Miss
signos de exclamación	exclamation marks: ¡ !
signos de interrogación	question marks: ¿ ?
Tengo ___ años.	I'm ___ years old.
tú	you (friendly: friends, family, kids)
usted	polite you
vocal	vowel
¡Hola!	Hello!
¿Cuántos años tienes?	How old are you?

¿Cuántos?	How many?
¿Cómo estás?	How are you?
¿Cómo se escribe?	How do you spell it?
¿Cómo te llamas?	What's your name?

Grade 4 Spanish

Student Textbook · 2026–2027

A full year of Grade 4 Spanish in short daily lessons. Students listen, speak, read, and write from the very first day, building real conversations step by step and exploring the people, places, and traditions of the Spanish-speaking world.

This Student Textbook teaches every lesson: the big idea, key vocabulary, models and examples, and a short set of practice problems to check understanding. It pairs with the Student Workbook and the Teacher Edition.

INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 ¡Hola!

IN THIS BOOK

- Clear lesson goals: “I can…” statements
- Key vocabulary with student-friendly definitions
- Models, examples, and Key Idea summaries
- A study guide and glossary for every unit

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook

You are holding this book



Workbook



Teacher Edition

Each lesson has the same number in all three books, and every day of the year is mapped to its lesson in the VenvLearning planner.